

Perspectives on Privacy and Information Disclosure

Course: Professional Practices

Lecture Objectives

- • Explain different perspectives on privacy
- • Understand the concept and importance of information disclosure
- • Identify examples of consumer and political backlash
- • Discuss ethical responsibilities of IT professionals

What is Privacy?

- • The right of individuals to control how their personal information is collected and used
- • Key Aspects:
 - - Freedom from intrusion
 - - Control over personal data
 - - Protection from unauthorized access
- • In IT: Related to data collection, surveillance, tracking, etc.

Perspectives on Privacy

- 1. Natural Right Perspective - Privacy as a human right
- 2. Utilitarian Perspective - Privacy may be limited for social benefit
- 3. Social Contract Perspective - Exchange of some privacy for online services

Professional Responsibility and Privacy

- • Protect user data from misuse
- • Follow privacy laws (e.g., GDPR, HIPAA)
- • Maintain transparency and confidentiality
- • Report unethical data practices

What is Information Disclosure?

- • Making private or sensitive information known to others
- • Types:
 - - Voluntary: User agrees to share data
 - - Involuntary: Data leaks, surveillance
- • Ethical Question: When is disclosure acceptable?

Ethical Issues in Information Disclosure

- • Unauthorized access or sharing
- • Selling consumer data
- • Inadequate protection policies
- • Lack of informed consent
- • Government or employer pressure

Balancing Privacy and Disclosure

- • Challenge: Finding balance between openness and protection
- • Examples:
 - - Medical data sharing vs. patient confidentiality
 - - Social media transparency vs. user safety
 - - Law enforcement surveillance vs. civil liberties

Case Study - Consumer Backlash

- Facebook-Cambridge Analytica (2018)
 - • Data collected without consent
 - • Used for political manipulation
 - • Results:
 - - Consumer outrage
 - - Legal action and fines
 - - Trust erosion in platforms

Case Study - Political Backlash

- Government Surveillance (Edward Snowden Case)
 - NSA's data collection revealed
 - Global political backlash
 - Debate on national security vs. personal privacy

Lessons Learned

- • Transparency builds trust
- • Ethical handling of data is vital
- • Respect user consent
- • Update public awareness and legal systems

Summary

- • Privacy: Core human value
- • Disclosure: Guided by consent and law
- • Backlashes show cost of violations
- • Professionals must protect user trust

Discussion Questions

- 1. Is total privacy possible in today's digital world?
- 2. When should companies disclose personal data to governments?
- 3. How can professionals maintain ethical standards?

References

- • Tavani, H. T. Ethics and Technology
- • Spinello, R. A. CyberEthics: Morality and Law in Cyberspace
- • Case reports: Cambridge Analytica, NSA Surveillance